Cursor Studio - Install Guide

Windows 11 - 24 cursor sets x 4 styles - every style ships as **Animated** (`.ani`) and **Static** (`.cur`). Choose the path that suits you:

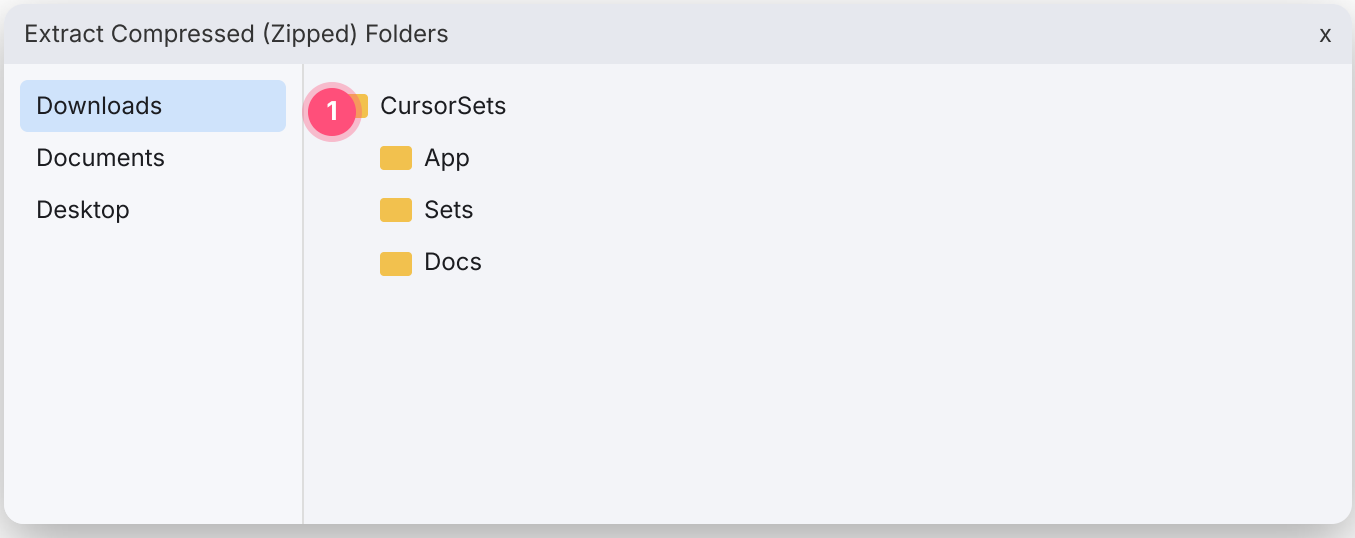
A **Cursor Studio app** (recommended, one click, no admin) B **Manual** via Mouse Properties C **Right-click Install.inf**

A Cursor Studio app - the 60 second route

Dark-mode installer included in `CursorSets\App`. It copies the cursors into your profile, registers the scheme and applies it instantly. Nothing needs administrator rights.

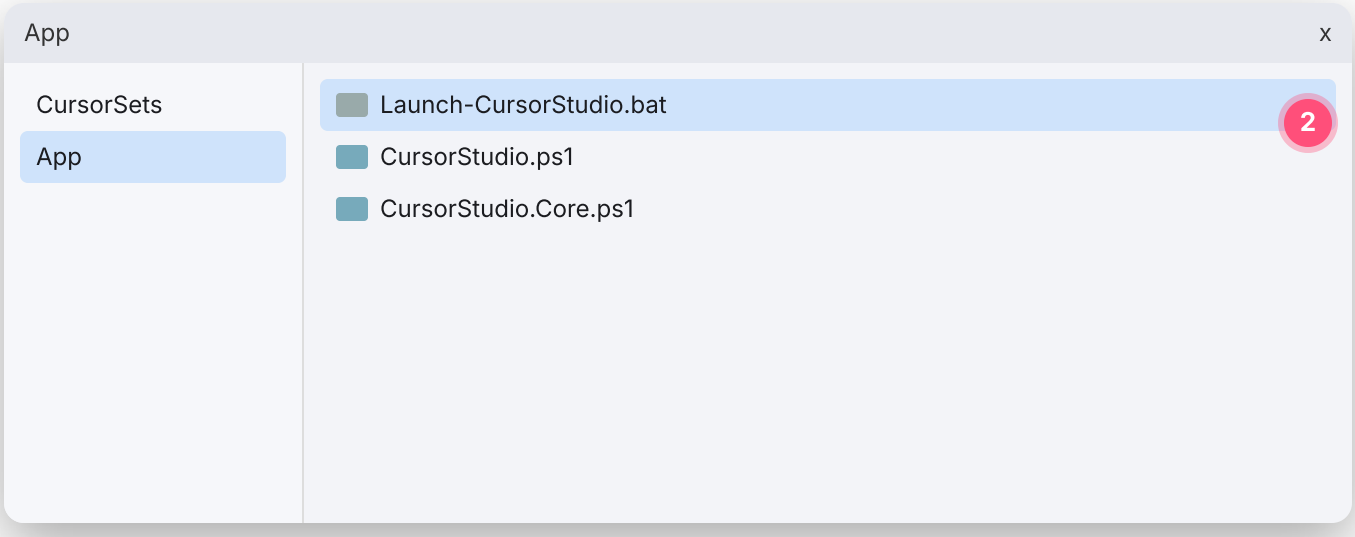
1 Get the folder

Download the repository (**Code → Download ZIP**), then right-click the zip and choose **Extract All...**. Keep the `CursorSets` folder together - the app reads the `Sets` folder next to it.



2 Launch it

Open `CursorSets\App` and double-click **Launch-CursorStudio.bat**. If SmartScreen appears: **More info → Run anyway** (the script is plain text you can read).



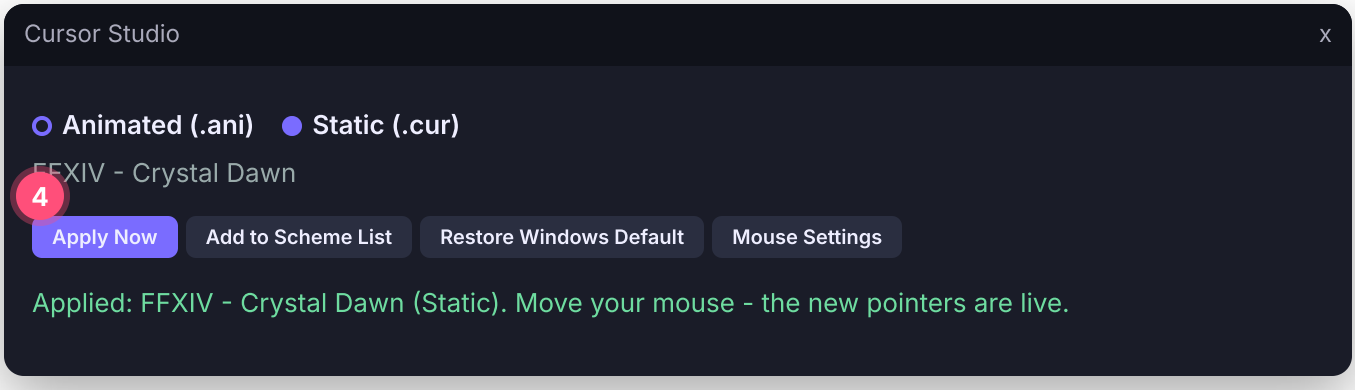
3 Pick a set and a style

Choose a set in the left list (grouped by franchise), then a style: **A** relic/weapon, **B** mascot, **C** gauntlet/HUD/pixel or **C2**. The preview shows all 17 pointers. Select **Animated (.ani)** or **Static (.cur)** - the preview switches to match.



4 Apply

Apply Now installs and activates the set immediately. **Add to Scheme List** only registers it so you can pick it later under *Mouse Settings → Pointers → Scheme*. **Restore Windows Default** undoes everything.



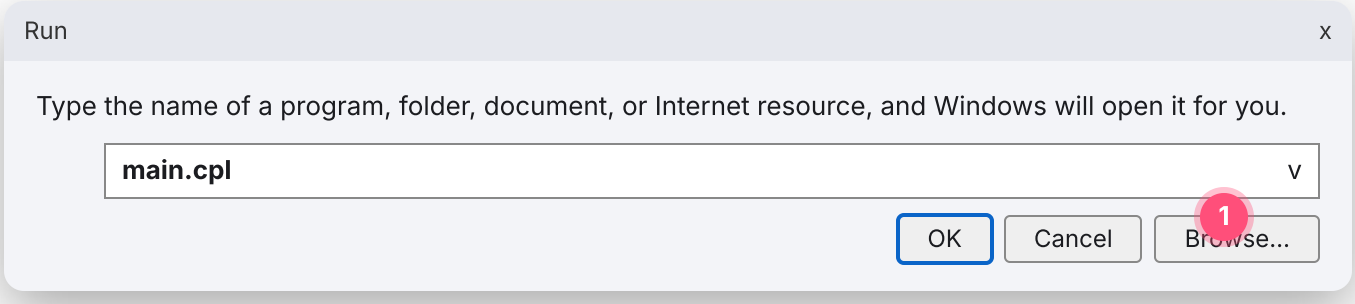
Headless / scripted: `powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File CursorStudio.ps1 -Set 01-Crystal-Dawn -Style A -Mode Animated -Apply` or `-List`, `-Restore`.

B Manual install - Mouse Properties

Works for **both** `.cur` and `.ani`. Repeat step 4 for each pointer, or use the app / the INF to do all 17 at once.

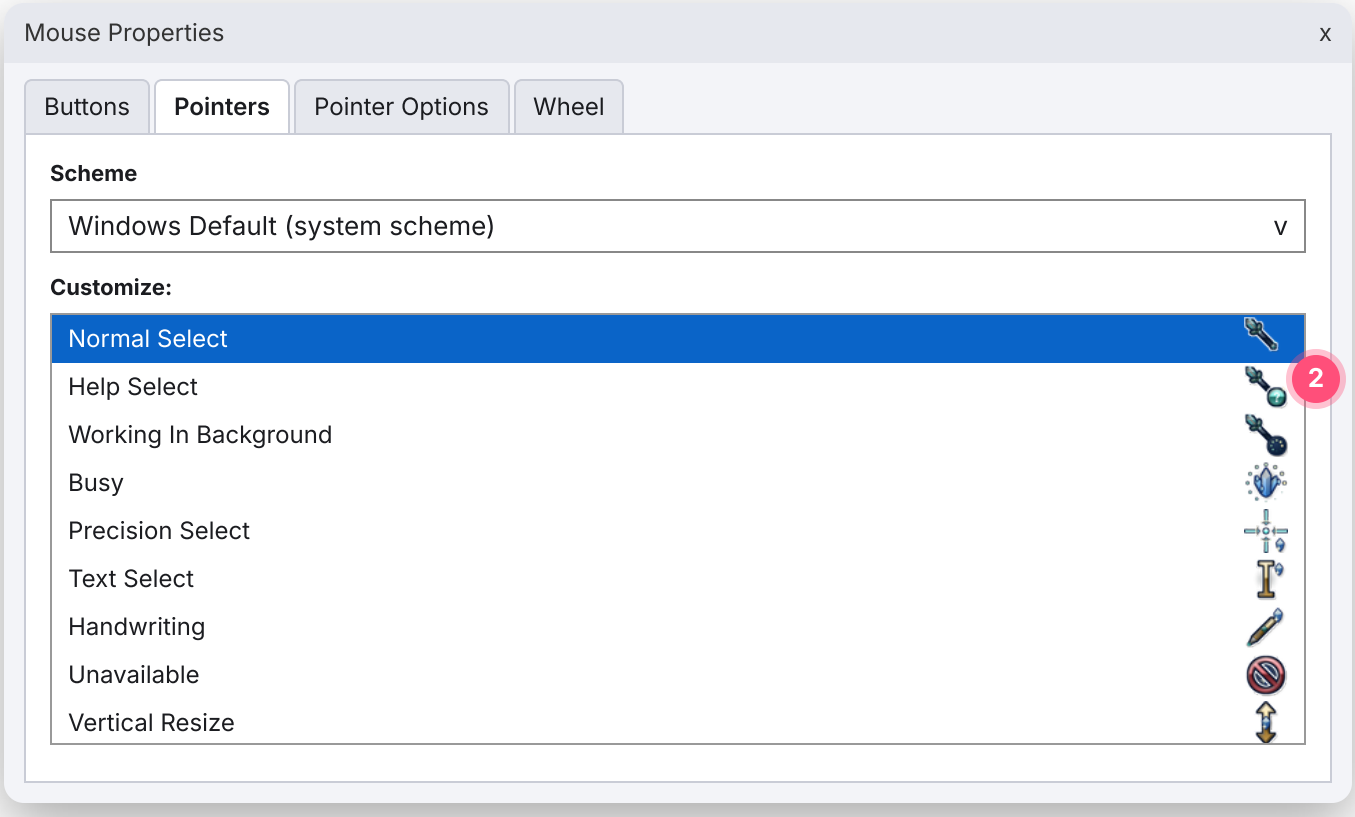
1 Open Mouse Properties

Press Win + R, type `main.cpl` and press Enter (or `control mouse`).



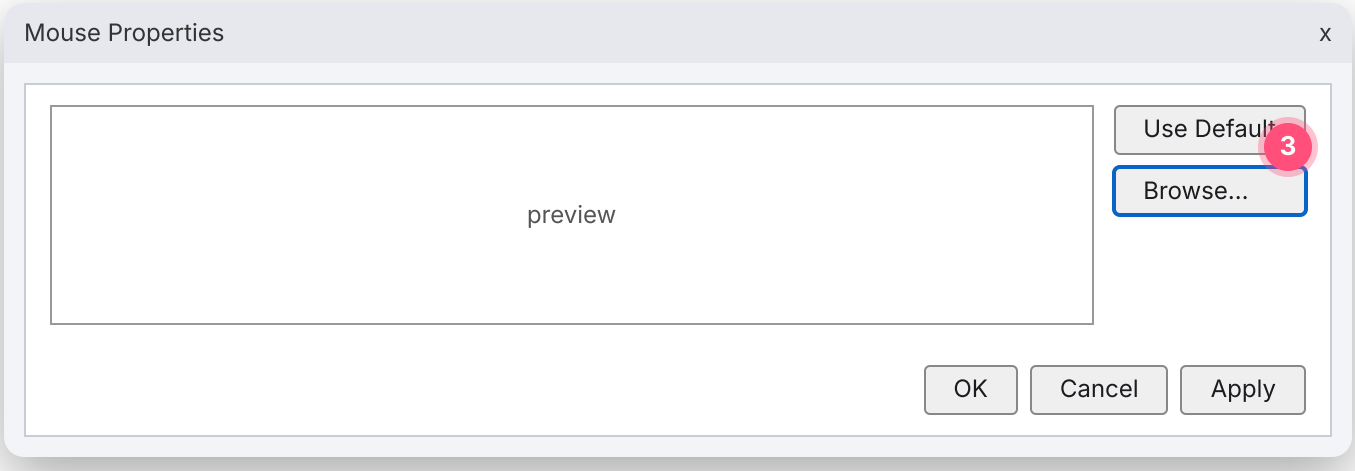
2 Pointers tab → select a role

Open the **Pointers** tab. In **Customize**, click a role such as **Normal Select** (the arrow). The 17 roles match the numbered file names `01-NormalSelect` … `17-PersonSelect`.



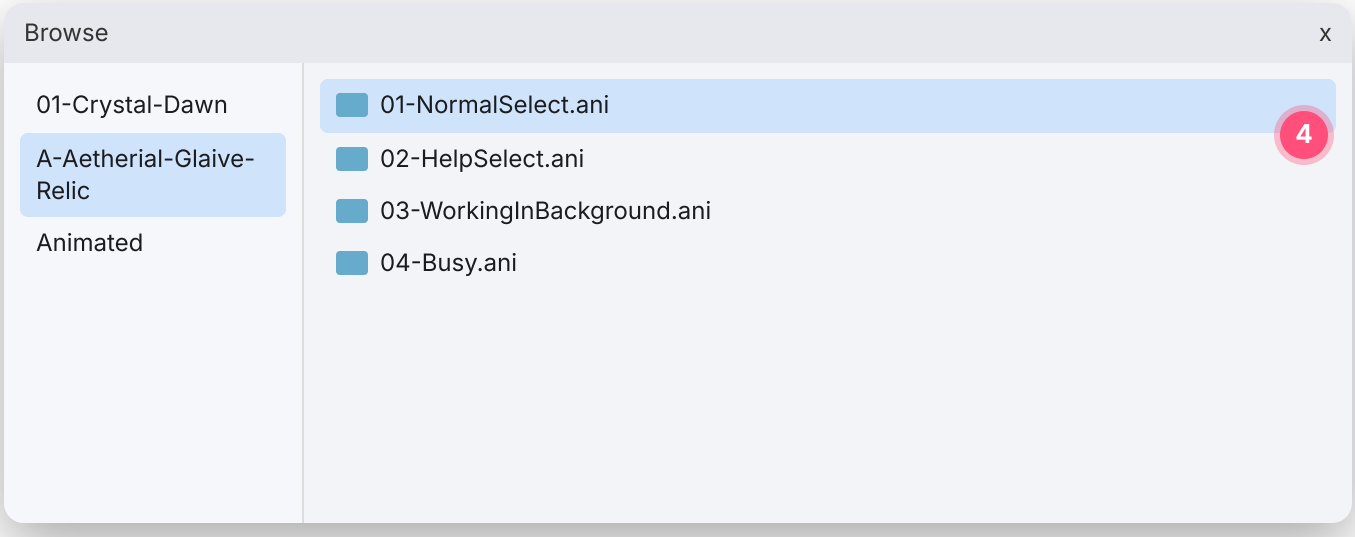
3 Browse...

Click **Browse...**. The folder opens at the Windows cursors folder - navigate to your set's `Animated` or `Static` folder.



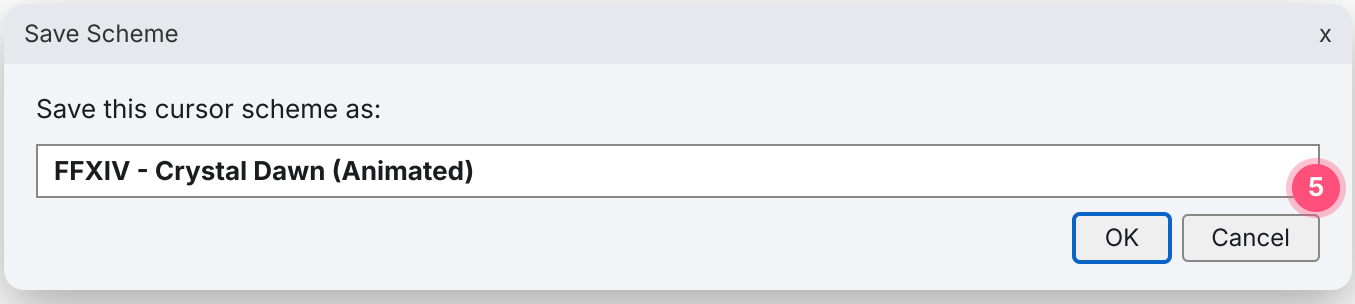
4 Pick the file, then Open

Choose the matching file (for example `01-NormalSelect.ani`) and click **Open**. Animated files preview in the box; **.cur** files show a still.



5 Save as a scheme, then Apply

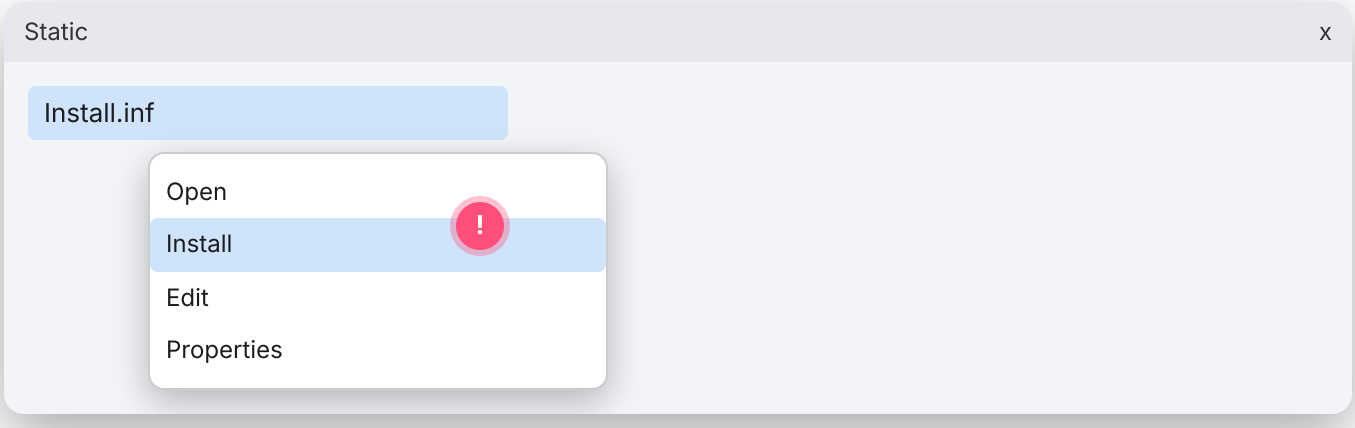
After all roles are set click **Save As...**, name it (for example *Crystal Dawn Animated*) and press **OK**. Next time just pick it in the **Scheme** drop-down and click **Apply**.



C One right-click: Install.inf

Register all 17 pointers at once

Open the set's `Animated` or `Static` folder, right-click **Install.inf** and choose **Install** (Windows 11: *Show more options* → *Install*). Approve the admin prompt - it copies the files to `C:\Windows\Cursors`. Then open `main.cpl` → Pointers and choose the new scheme in the **Scheme** list.



Switching between Animated and Static



Static - 17 crisp `.cur` pointers.



Animated - the same 17 roles as looping `.ani` pointers.

In the app, flip the radio button and press **Apply Now** again. Manually, choose the other scheme in the **Scheme** drop-down. Each variant is registered as its own scheme (*Set Name (Animated)* / *(Static)*).

Sizes & sharpness

> Every cursor file contains **32, 48 and 64 px** images, so Windows can pick the closest match for your pointer size and display scale instead of stretching one bitmap. To enlarge pointers: **Settings → Accessibility → Mouse pointer and touch → Size**.

Folder map

```
CursorSets/
 catalog.json                     list of all sets
 App/   Launch-CursorStudio.bat   dark-mode installer (PowerShell, no install needed)
        CursorStudio.ps1 / .Core.ps1
 Docs/  Install-Guide.html / .png this sheet
 Sets/
  01-Crystal-Dawn/ ... 24-Spooky-Paws/      24 sets
    A-<name>/ B-<name>/ C-<name>/ C2-<name>/   4 styles per set
```

```
      Static/    01-NormalSelect.cur ... 17-PersonSelect.cur + Install.inf
      Animated/  01-NormalSelect.ani ... 17-PersonSelect.ani + Install.inf
Previews/<set>/<style>/   card.png/.gif, board.png/.gif, cursor32.png
Selector.html                     browser selector with live hover test
Generator/                        Python source that renders everything (see HANDOFF.md)
```

The 17 pointer roles

#	Windows name	Registry key	File
1	Normal Select	`Arrow`	`01-NormalSelect`
2	Help Select	`Help`	`02-HelpSelect`
3	Working In Background	`AppStarting`	`03-WorkingInBackground`
4	Busy	`Wait`	`04-Busy`
5	Precision Select	`Crosshair`	`05-PrecisionSelect`
6	Text Select	`IBeam`	`06-TextSelect`
7	Handwriting	`NWPen`	`07-Handwriting`
8	Unavailable	`No`	`08-Unavailable`
9	Vertical Resize	`SizeNS`	`09-VerticalResize`
10	Horizontal Resize	`SizeWE`	`10-HorizontalResize`
11	Diagonal Resize 1	`SizeNWSE`	`11-DiagonalResize1`
12	Diagonal Resize 2	`SizeNESW`	`12-DiagonalResize2`
13	Move	`SizeAll`	`13-Move`
14	Alternate Select	`UpArrow`	`14-AlternateSelect`
15	Link Select	`Hand`	`15-LinkSelect`
16	Location Select	`Pin`	`16-LocationSelect`
17	Person Select	`Person`	`17-PersonSelect`

Troubleshooting

Animated pointer does not move	Make sure the slot points to a `.ani` file. Re-apply the **Animated** scheme. A few remote-desktop and game-capture tools show static cursors only.
Blurry cursor	Set *Accessibility → Mouse pointer size* to a step that matches your display scale; every file ships 32/48/64 px.
Script blocked	Use the `.bat` launcher (it bypasses the policy for this one run) or run the headless command shown in section A.
Go back	Press **Restore Windows Default**, or in Pointers pick *Windows Default* from the Scheme list.

Making your own animated pointer? RealWorld Cursor Editor (GIF/strip → .ani with hotspots) and Custom Cursors Studio (Microsoft Store) both work. The generator in `CursorSets/Generator` shows how these sets are built.